

Success Story of: Sphamandla Tshabalala's Journey at Afrika Tikkun

For two long years, the job search felt like navigating a digital desert. I was only armed with an NCV Level 4 in Information Technology and Computer Science, and I felt like my potential was locked away. I took a role as a Store Associate at Mr Price to make ends meet, dedicating 12 months to assisting customers and unpacking stock. But I knew my true calling lay in the complex, demanding world of technology.

My turning point came when I decided to leave the familiar path of retail, seeking a new and formidable challenge—a quest for knowledge that led me to **Afrika Tikkun Services**. In March 2025, I sat before Patricia Banda for an interview, a pivotal moment that confirmed my journey forward: I was recommended as a candidate.

The real transformation began on May 19, 2025, when I commenced the **PLP CDP (SA) – Cybersecurity** candidacy programme. This was no ordinary training; it was a forge for a new career. I immersed myself in highly specialized fields, mastering the art of the defensive and the offensive. My curriculum included becoming a **Junior Cybersecurity Analyst** and specializing in **Ethical Hacking**. I gained proficiency in crucial certifications like **CompTIA Security+** and foundational knowledge in new technologies like **AI Fundamentals with IBM Skills Build**.

The program, set to conclude on 24 October 2025, marked the end of my time as an unemployed job seeker and the true beginning of my professional life. Today, I am no longer the Store Associate; I am a certified and recommended cybersecurity professional, ready to tackle the threats of the digital world. My story is a testament to the power of a single opportunity and the dedication required to transform a locked potential into a formidable skill set. I traded store aisles for network layers, and retail boxes for security protocols, forging a new and successful path with Afrika Tikkun Service which I will always be grateful for.